AUTO TICKET CLASSIFICATION USING FLOW DESIGNER

Project Planning Phase – Project Plan

Platform: ServiceNow | Project Type: IT Helpdesk Automation

1. Project Overview

Auto Ticket Classification using Flow Designer is a ServiceNow automation project designed to reduce manual effort in classifying IT helpdesk incidents. The project will analyze incident request text and apply predefined classification rules to identify the appropriate Category and Subcategory. The planning phase establishes the project goals, scope, responsibilities, activities, resources, schedule, risks, and expected deliverables before implementation begins.

2. Project Goal

The primary goal is to plan and develop a reliable automated process that can classify common IT support tickets such as Wi-Fi issues, projector failures, password problems, and slow-computer complaints. The project should produce a working ServiceNow Flow Designer solution that can be demonstrated using realistic incident examples.

3. Project Objectives

- Understand the current manual ticket-classification process and identify automation opportunities.
- Define the incident information required for classification.
- Prepare a clear list of issue categories, subcategories, and classification keywords.
- Build and configure the automation using ServiceNow Flow Designer.
- Test the flow using multiple incident scenarios.
- Validate the classification output and document the completed solution.

4. Project Scope

In Scope	Out of Scope / Future Scope
Incident classification using Short Description and Description.	Advanced AI/ML-based classification.
Predefined keyword/condition rules.	External helpdesk platforms and integrations.
Category and Subcategory assignment.	Complex predictive analytics.
Flow Designer implementation and testing.	Large-scale production deployment beyond project requirements.

5. Success Criteria

- The planned flow can classify the defined sample incident types.
- The required Category and Subcategory values are assigned correctly.
- The flow completes without errors during testing.
- Unmatched incidents have a defined fallback path.
- The team can demonstrate the complete ticket-classification workflow.

PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

6. Work Breakdown Structure

Phase	Major Activities	Output
1. Requirement Planning	Understand use case, users, ticket types and expected automation.	Requirement list
2. Environment Preparation	Verify ServiceNow access, roles and project setup.	Ready development environment
3. Data & Rule Planning	Define categories, subcategories, keywords and rule priority.	Classification rule set
4. Flow Development	Create trigger, conditions, branches and record update actions.	Working Flow Designer flow
5. Testing	Run positive, negative and fallback test scenarios.	Test results
6. Documentation & Demo	Prepare project documentation and final demonstration.	Final project package

7. Activity Schedule

Activity	Planned Duration	Dependency	Milestone
Requirement Analysis	Day 1	Project start	Requirements approved
Project & Environment Setup	Day 1–2	Access availability	Environment ready
Classification Rule Preparation	Day 2–3	Requirements	Rule matrix completed
Flow Development	Day 3–5	Rule matrix	Flow created
Testing & Correction	Day 5–6	Working flow	Tests passed
Documentation & Demonstration	Day 6–7	Validated solution	Final demo ready

8. Team Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Team Lead	Coordinate activities, track progress, review deliverables and organize final demonstration.
ServiceNow Developer	Configure Flow Designer, conditions, actions and Incident updates.
Requirement / Documentation Member	Prepare requirements, rule mapping, test cases and project documentation.
Testing Member	Execute test scenarios, record results and report defects.

9. Planning Dependencies

- ServiceNow instance access and required user permissions.
- Availability of Incident table and required classification fields.
- Agreement on Category/Subcategory values and keyword rules.
- Team coordination for development, testing, and documentation.

PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

10. Resource Planning

Resource	Purpose	Planned Use
ServiceNow Instance	Development and testing environment.	Flow creation and execution testing.
Flow Designer	Automation development tool.	Trigger, conditions and update actions.
Incident Table	Ticket data source and output record.	Classification input and result storage.
Project Documentation	Requirements, planning, testing and final records.	Project submission and demonstration.
Team Members	Development, review and testing activities.	Collaborative project execution.

11. Risk Management Plan

Risk	Impact	Planned Mitigation
ServiceNow access issue	Development delay	Verify access and roles at the beginning.
Incorrect keyword match	Wrong classification	Use specific rules and test overlapping keywords.
Missing classification value	Flow update failure	Validate Category/Subcategory choices before testing.
Unclear requirements	Rework	Confirm rule matrix before development.
Team coordination delay	Schedule impact	Assign responsibilities and review progress regularly.

12. Monitoring & Progress Tracking

- Track each activity from requirement analysis through final demonstration.
- Record completed tasks and pending tasks after each work session.
- Review failed test cases and assign corrective actions.
- Maintain the latest version of the classification rule matrix.
- Confirm that final documentation reflects the implemented flow.

13. Planned Deliverables

- Project requirement and scope document.
- Classification keyword/rule matrix.
- Configured ServiceNow Flow Designer automation.
- Test case and validation results.
- Project planning and design documentation.
- Final project demonstration / presentation material.

14. Project Completion Plan

The project will be considered ready for completion after the required flow is configured, representative incidents are successfully classified, fallback handling is verified, test results are recorded, and the team completes the final demonstration. Any remaining issues should be documented and resolved or clearly identified as future enhancements.

15. Final Planning Summary

This planning document provides a structured roadmap for developing the Auto Ticket Classification using Flow Designer project. It establishes the project goal, scope, work breakdown, schedule, responsibilities, resources, dependencies, risks, monitoring approach, and deliverables. Following this plan will help the team move systematically from requirements to implementation, testing, documentation, and final demonstration.